

90-Day Professional Capstone

Capture Strategy Development Project

Project Overview

- **Time to Complete:** 5-7 business days
- **Deliverables:** 4 written artifacts (templates provided)
- **Evaluation:** Facilitator review using standardized rubric
- **Passing Criteria:** All 4 deliverables meet minimum requirements
- **Format:** Individual submission (no team projects)

The Scenario

OPPORTUNITY BRIEFING

Contract: Enterprise IT Service Desk Support

Agency: Department of Veterans Affairs (VA), Office of Information Technology

Contract Value: \$18M over 5 years (base + 4 option years)

Contract Type: Firm Fixed Price (FFP)

Set-Aside: Small Business (unrestricted among small businesses)

NAICS: 541512 — Computer Systems Design Services

Current Status: Recompete — RFP expected in 45 days

Award Timeline: 6 months from RFP release

Background Information

The Opportunity

The VA's current IT service desk contract expires in 8 months. The incumbent, **TechServe Solutions** (a mid-sized small business), has held this contract for 6 years through one recompetes and two option year extensions.

The service desk supports 400,000+ VA employees and contractors across 1,200 facilities nationwide. Current scope includes:

- Tier 1 and Tier 2 help desk support (phone, email, chat)
- Password resets and account management
- Hardware/software troubleshooting
- Ticket escalation and tracking
- Monthly performance reporting

Customer Pain Points

Based on publicly available information (Congressional testimony, VA OIG reports, and industry day materials), the VA has expressed concerns about:

1. **Response Times:** Average ticket resolution exceeds SLA targets by 15%
2. **Customer Satisfaction:** End-user satisfaction scores have declined from 82% to 74% over 3 years
3. **Modernization:** The current system lacks AI-powered self-service capabilities
4. **Staffing:** High turnover among help desk agents (35% annual turnover)
5. **Reporting:** Leadership wants better analytics and dashboards

Incumbent Analysis

TechServe Solutions:

- Revenue: \$45M annually
- Employees: 280
- Years on contract: 6
- Performance ratings: "Satisfactory" (not "Exceptional")
- Known for: Low cost, adequate delivery
- Weakness: Technology is dated, high staff turnover, reactive not proactive

Your Company Profile

Your company (for this exercise):

- Revenue: \$22M annually
- Employees: 150
- Small business (not 8(a), not SDVOSB)
- Relevant experience: Two similar service desk contracts with DoD (smaller scale, \$5M each)
- Strength: Modern technology platform with AI chatbot, low turnover (12%), high CSAT scores (91%)

- Weakness: No prior VA experience, smaller than incumbent
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Your Assignment

You are the **Capture Lead** for this opportunity. Leadership has given you a “yellow light” to pursue — meaning you can invest capture resources, but you need to build a compelling case.

Your job: Develop the capture strategy artifacts that will guide your team’s pursuit of this opportunity.

Required Deliverables

You must submit **all four deliverables** to pass the capstone. Templates are provided at the end of this document.

Deliverable 1: Opportunity Qualification Summary (1 page)

Complete the qualification template answering:

- Why should we pursue this opportunity?
- What are the key risks and how will we mitigate them?
- What is our preliminary Pwin (probability of win) assessment?
- What must be true for us to win?

Deliverable 2: Competitive Analysis (1 page)

Using the competitive analysis template:

- Assess the incumbent’s strengths and weaknesses
- Identify at least one other likely competitor (you may create a realistic fictional competitor)
- Map your strengths against competitor weaknesses
- Identify your vulnerabilities and mitigation strategies

Deliverable 3: Win Theme Development (1 page)

Develop **three win themes** that:

- Directly address customer pain points
- Differentiate your company from the incumbent
- Are specific and provable (not generic marketing language)
- Follow the format: “We offer [benefit] through [proof point], which means [customer outcome]”

Deliverable 4: Customer Engagement Plan (1 page)

Create a 45-day pre-RFP engagement plan that includes:

- Key stakeholders to engage (by role, not name)
- Engagement activities (meetings, industry days, etc.)
- Information you need to gather

- Ethical boundaries you will observe

Important Notes

- **Use the templates provided** — do not create your own format
- **Be specific** — generic answers will not pass
- **Stay realistic** — don't invent capabilities your fictional company doesn't have
- **Keep it concise** — each deliverable is limited to 1 page
- **This is a simulation** — do not contact the actual VA or any government employees

Deliverable Templates

Template 1: Opportunity Qualification Summary

Opportunity: VA Enterprise IT Service Desk Support

Pursuit Recommendation: (Green / Yellow / Red)

Why We Should Pursue (3-4 sentences):

Top 3 Risks and Mitigations:

Risk	Mitigation

Preliminary Pwin: %

Rationale (2-3 sentences):

Must-Win Conditions (what must be true for us to win):

Template 2: Competitive Analysis

Incumbent: TechServe Solutions

Strengths	Weaknesses

Other Likely Competitor:

Strengths	Weaknesses

Our Competitive Position:

Our Strengths (vs. competitors)	Our Vulnerabilities

Ghosting Strategy (how we highlight our strengths against their weaknesses without naming them):

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Template 3: Win Theme Development

Instructions: Each win theme must address a customer pain point, be specific, and be provable.

Win Theme 1:

Customer Pain Point Addressed:

Theme Statement:

“We offer

[benefit]

through

[proof point],

which means

[customer outcome].“

Win Theme 2:

Customer Pain Point Addressed:

Theme Statement:

“We offer

[benefit]

through

[proof point],

which means

[customer outcome].“

Win Theme 3:

GovCon BD Upskilling Program |
Customer Pain Point Addressed:
GovCon Giants

Template 4: Customer Engagement Plan (45 Days Pre-RFP)

Key Stakeholders to Engage:

Role	Why Important	Engagement Approach

Planned Engagement Activities:

Week	Activity	Goal
1-2		
3-4		
5-6		

Information We Need to Gather:

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Ethical Boundaries (what we will NOT do):

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Submit all 4 completed templates to your facilitator for evaluation.

